as assistant secretary provided the finalized details.[30] Apart from the enhanced authorized capital, there was a new provision, not seen in the first iteration, that only Asians could take shares. Though no Europeans were queueing up to take shares, the promoters were making a political point—SSNCo was to be a Swadeshi company in its ownership. This had the intended effect of raising the hackles of Europeans. During the security proceedings of the Swadeshi vakils later, Joint Magistrate Ashe asked if the prohibition of non-Asians holding shares was even legal, as did Governor Lawley himself when he met the Tinnevelly Deputation.[31]

Further far-sighted objectives were added to the prospectus.

> To popularize the art of navigation to the Indians, Ceylonese and other nations of the east … To impart practical instructions in the art of ship-building to the Indians, Ceylonese and other eastern nations. To establish schools for teaching the Indian, Ceylonese and other Asiatic students the theoretical portions of the art of navigation as well as the rudiments of the art of ship-building. To promote and bring about union and co-operation among the Indians, Ceylonese and the other nations of the east with regard to navigation and trade. To employ Indians, Ceylonese and other Asiatic travelling agents for studying the questions concerning the demand and supply in various commercial centres. To open docks and yards for the cleaning, repairing and building of steam-ships, sailing vessels, steam launches, boats, etc.[32]

Easy though it is to dismiss these as idealistic and impractical, this is what marked out SSNCo from other ventures.

All its stationery and signboards had ‘Vande/Bande Mataram’ emblazoned on them,[33] and its publicity material was printed at presses with obvious Swadeshi overtones in their names such as the Desabhimani Press, Cuddalore and the Swadesa Baskaran Press, Tuticorin.

In terms of management, the most significant was the entry of P. Pandithurai Thevar as president, director, and officiating secretary of the company. VOC was assistant secretary.[34] Enshrined in the Articles of Association, this formal position acknowledged VOC’s central role in promoting the company. By mid-November Messrs Haji Fakir Mohammed Sait became secretary, succeeding Pandithurai after his all-too-brief tenure as officiating secretary; but, by the first week of January 1907, if not even